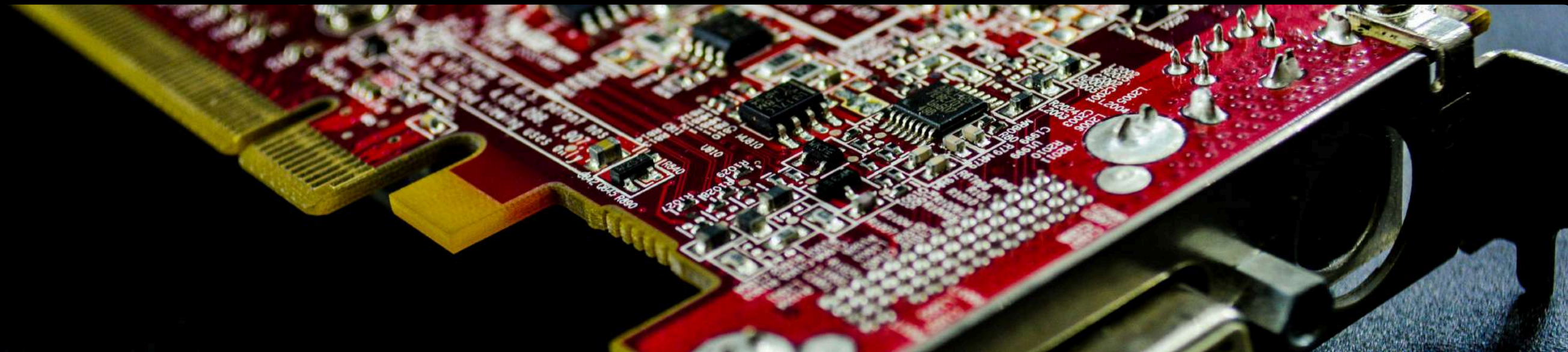


PHISHING AWARENESS & CYBER SAFETY

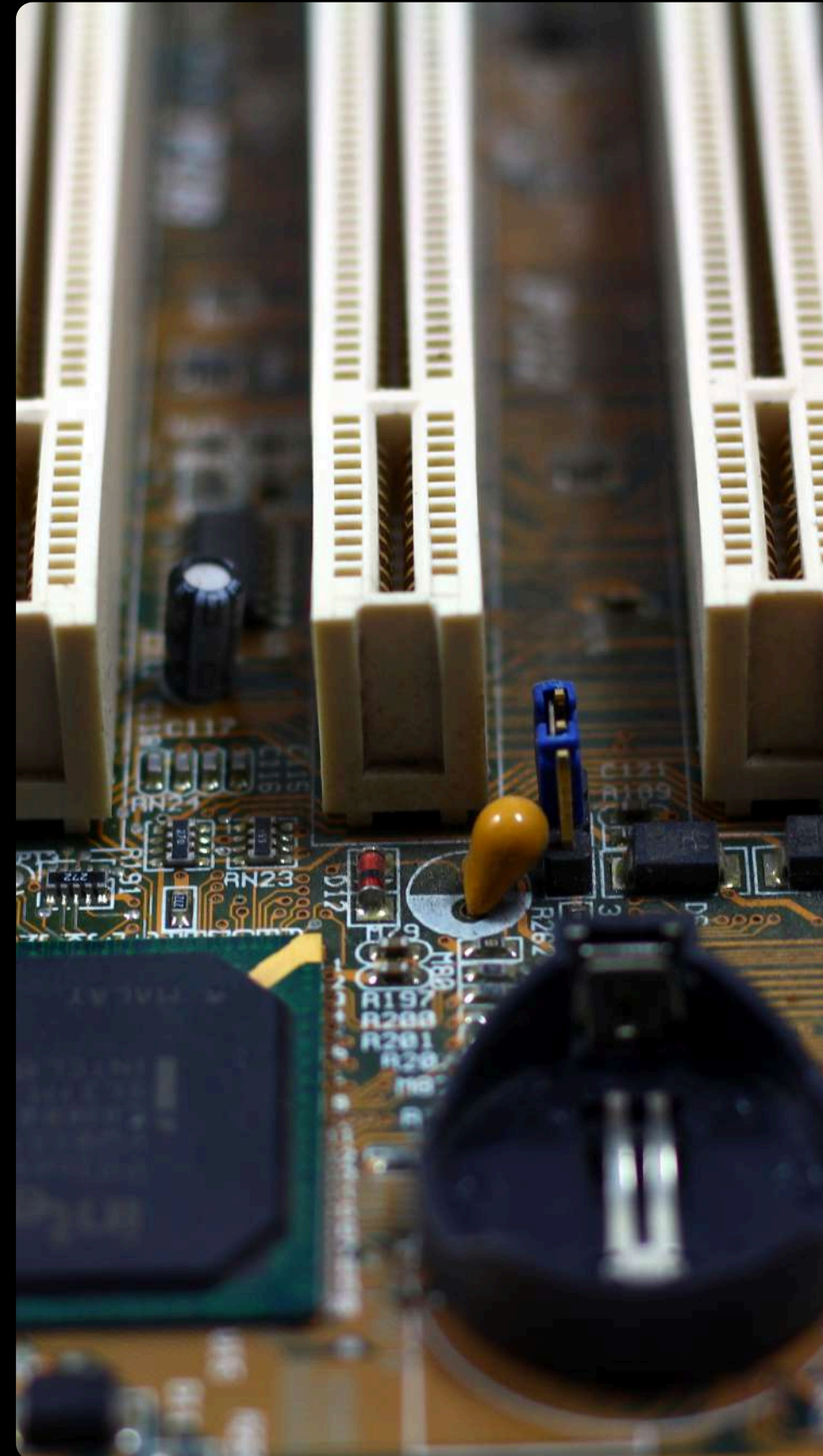
PRESENTATION

Internship:
Cyber Security Internship at CodeAlpha



INTRODUCTION TO CYBER SECURITY

Cybersecurity is the process of protecting computers, mobile devices, servers, networks, and digital data from cyberattacks and unauthorized access. As technology and internet usage continue to grow rapidly, cyber threats are also increasing every day. Individuals and organizations are becoming targets of online scams, malware attacks, ransomware, and phishing campaigns. Cybersecurity helps ensure confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information while protecting users from financial and personal losses.

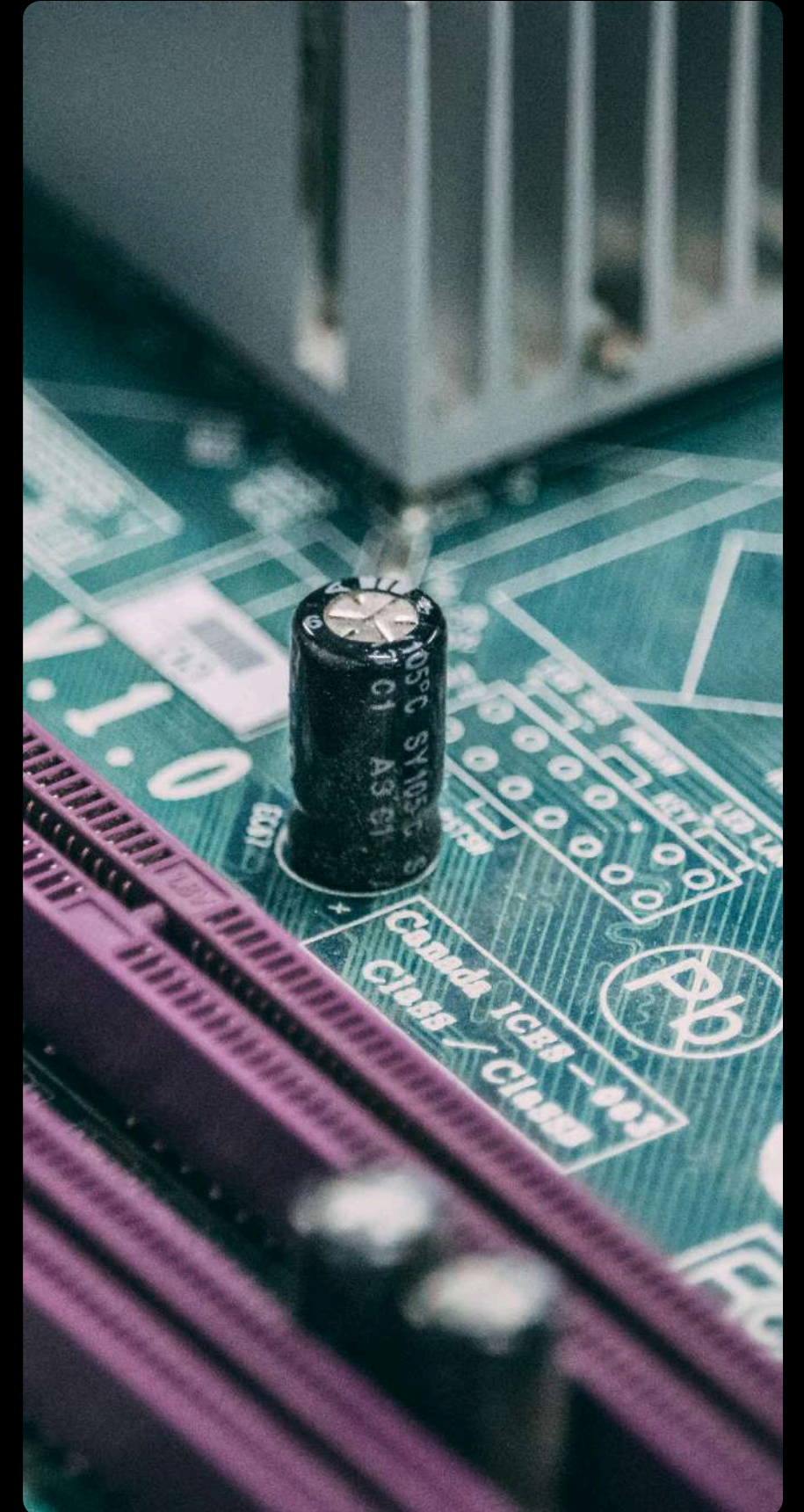


COMMON CYBER THREATS

Cyber threats are malicious activities performed by attackers to damage, steal, or gain unauthorized access to computer systems, networks, and sensitive information. As internet usage and digital communication continue to increase, cyber threats have become more advanced and dangerous. Individuals, businesses, and organizations face various forms of cyberattacks that can lead to financial losses, data breaches, identity theft, and system failures. Understanding common cyber threats helps users stay aware and take preventive security measures.

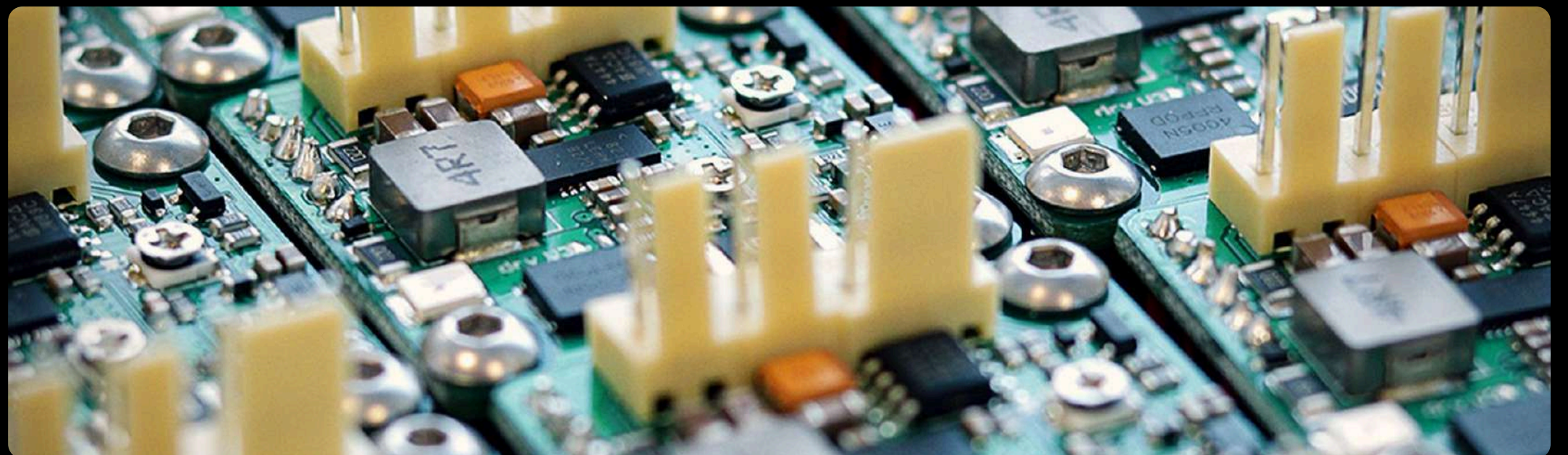
THE IMPORTANCE OF DATA PROTECTION

Data protection helps maintain the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information. Confidentiality ensures that only authorized users can access data. Integrity ensures that data remains accurate and unaltered, while availability ensures that information is accessible when needed. These principles form the foundation of cybersecurity and information security practices.



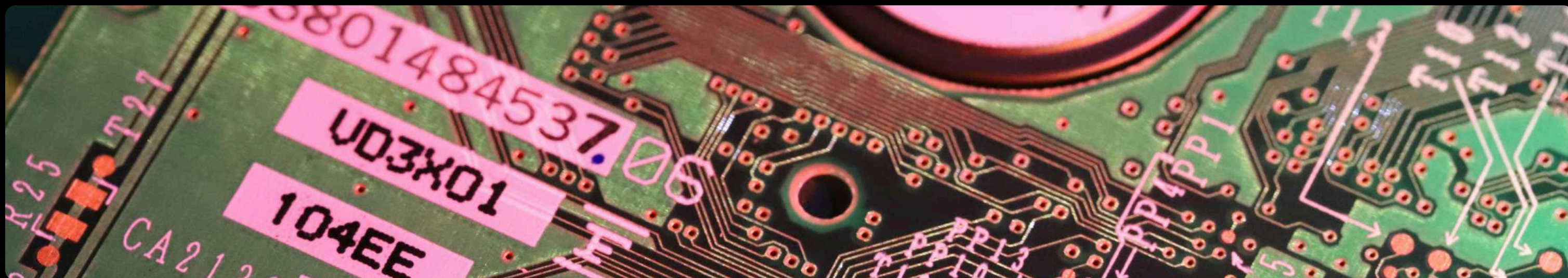
CYBER ATTACK TRENDS

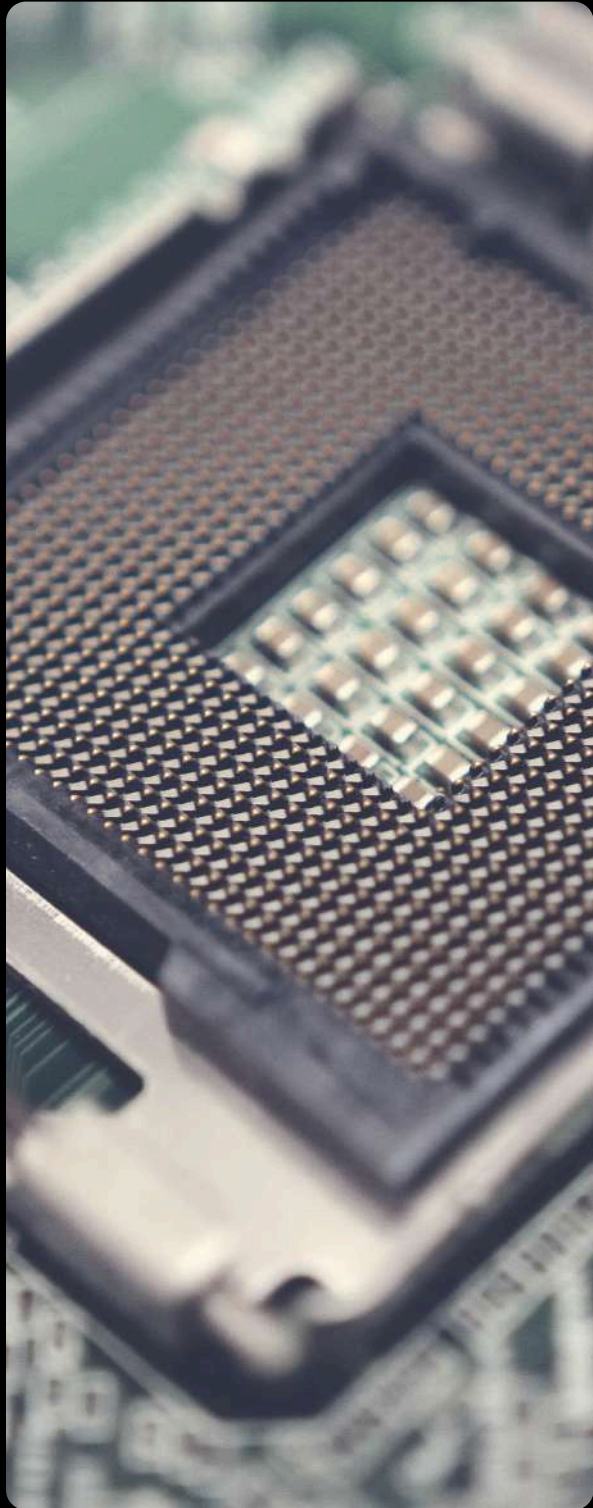
Cyber attacks are continuously increasing as technology becomes more advanced and internet usage expands across the world. Cybercriminals are developing new techniques to target individuals, businesses, governments, and organizations for financial gain, data theft, espionage, and disruption of services. Modern cyberattacks are becoming more sophisticated, automated, and difficult to detect, making cybersecurity an essential requirement in today's digital environment.



Phishing is a type of cyberattack in which attackers pretend to be trusted individuals, companies, or organizations to steal sensitive information from victims. Attackers usually send fake emails, SMS messages, or create fraudulent websites that look similar to legitimate ones. Their main objective is to manipulate users into entering passwords, credit card details, OTPs, or personal data. Phishing attacks are dangerous because they exploit human emotions such as fear, urgency, trust, and curiosity.

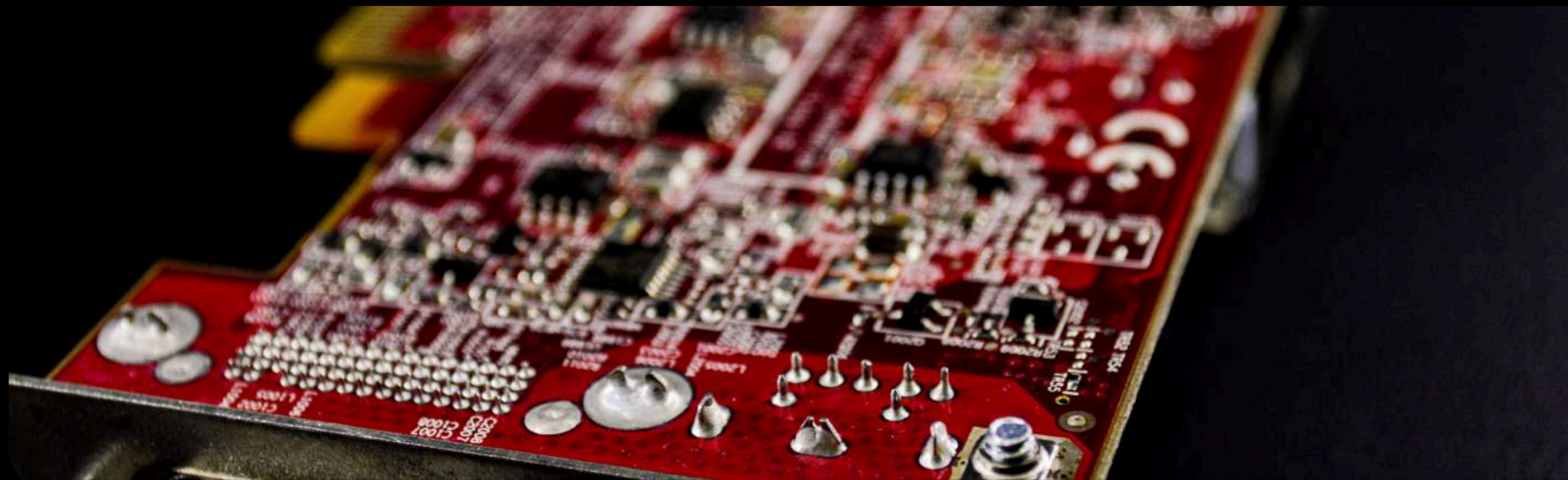
PHISHING AWARENESS





HOW PHISHING ATTACKS WORK

A phishing attack generally follows a simple but dangerous process. First, the attacker creates a fake email, website, or message that appears genuine. The victim then receives the message with urgent or attractive content, such as warnings about account suspension or prize winnings. Once the victim clicks the malicious link, they are redirected to a fake website where they unknowingly enter confidential information. Finally, the attacker collects the stolen information and may use it for financial fraud, identity theft, or unauthorized access.



TYPES OF PHISHING ATTACKS

There are several types of phishing attacks used by cybercriminals. Email phishing involves fake emails pretending to come from banks, companies, or online services. Smishing refers to phishing through SMS messages, while vishing uses phone calls to deceive victims.

Spear phishing targets specific individuals or organizations with personalized messages, making the attack more convincing. Clone phishing involves copying legitimate emails and replacing genuine links with malicious ones. These attacks continue evolving as attackers become more sophisticated.

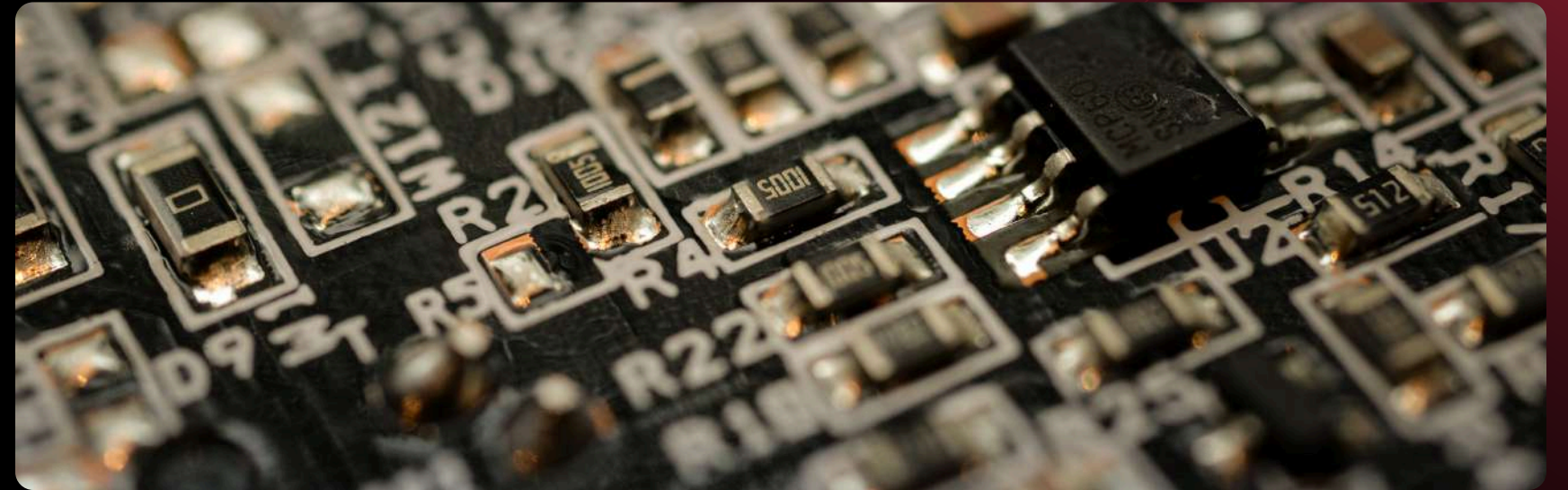
REAL-LIFE PHISHING EXAMPLE



One common phishing example is receiving an email claiming that a bank account will be blocked within 24 hours unless immediate verification is completed. The message often includes a suspicious link directing users to a fake login page that resembles the real bank website.

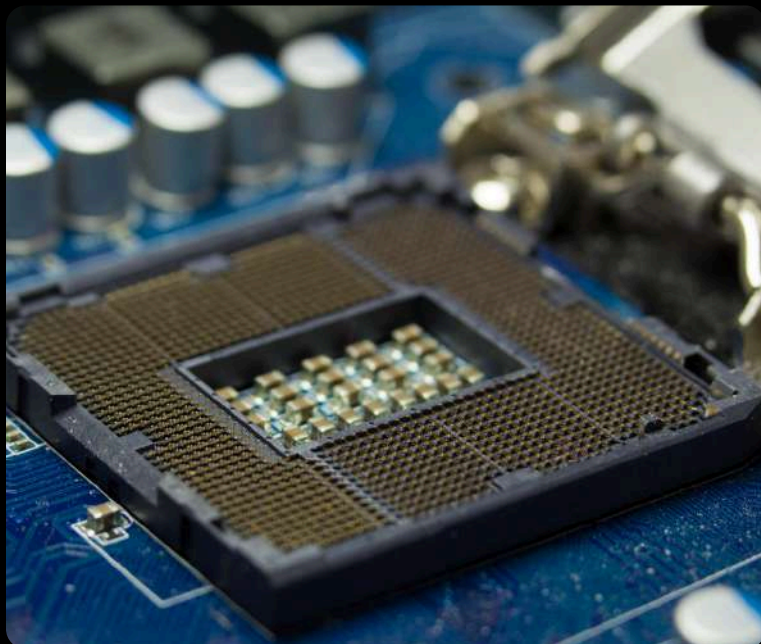
Warning signs usually include grammatical mistakes, urgent language, unusual email addresses, and suspicious URLs. Legitimate organizations never ask users to share passwords, PINs, or OTPs through emails or messages.

Cybercriminals frequently create fake websites that look almost identical to real websites in order to steal user information. Users should always check website URLs carefully before entering login credentials or payment details. For example, attackers may replace letters with similar-looking characters, such as using “paypa1.com” instead of “paypal.com.” Secure websites usually use HTTPS and display a padlock symbol in the browser. Poor design quality, spelling mistakes, excessive advertisements, and suspicious domain names are also signs of fraudulent websites.



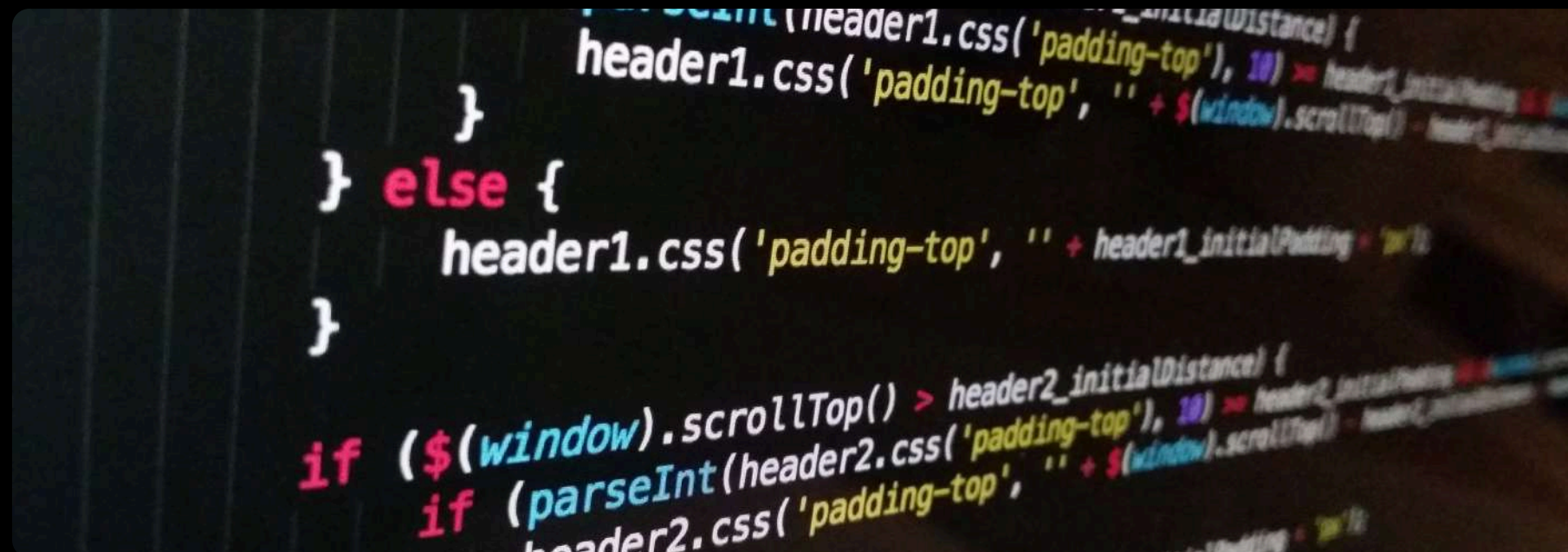
IDENTIFYING FAKE WEBSITES

SOCIAL ENGINEERING IN PHISHING



Social engineering is a psychological manipulation technique used by attackers to trick individuals into making security mistakes. Instead of attacking computer systems directly, attackers target human emotions and behavior. They create fear, urgency, excitement, or trust to pressure victims into acting quickly without thinking carefully. Common examples include fake lottery winnings, urgent payment requests, account suspension warnings, or impersonating technical support teams. Social engineering is highly effective because it exploits human psychology rather than technical vulnerabilities.

Phishing attacks can have serious consequences for both individuals and organizations. Victims may lose money, suffer identity theft, or experience unauthorized access to social media and banking accounts. Organizations may face data breaches, financial losses, reputational damage, and operational disruptions. In many cases, stolen credentials are used for further cyberattacks. As phishing attacks continue increasing worldwide, cybersecurity awareness and education have become essential for protecting users and businesses from digital threats.



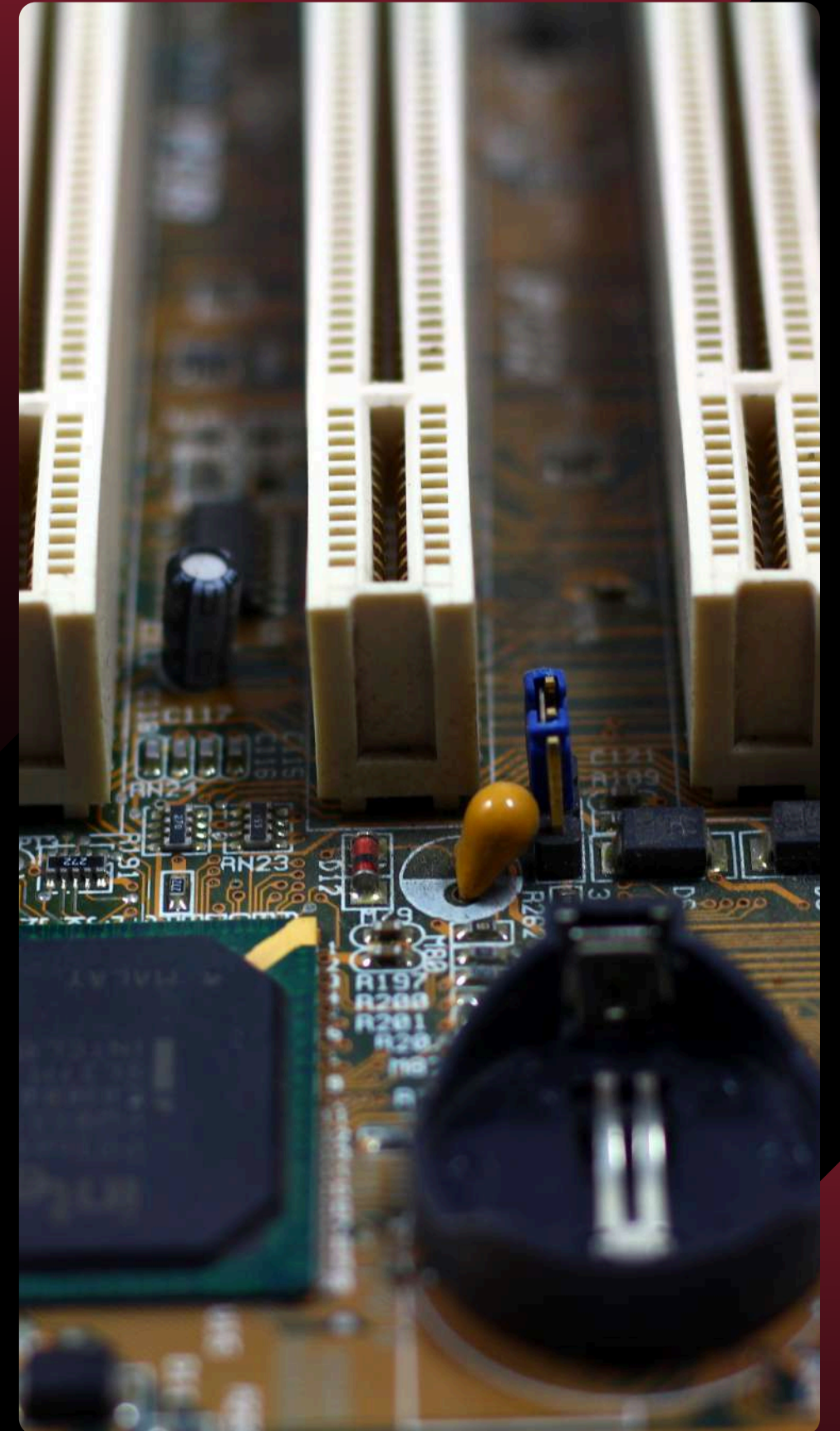
IMPACT OF PHISHING ATTACKS

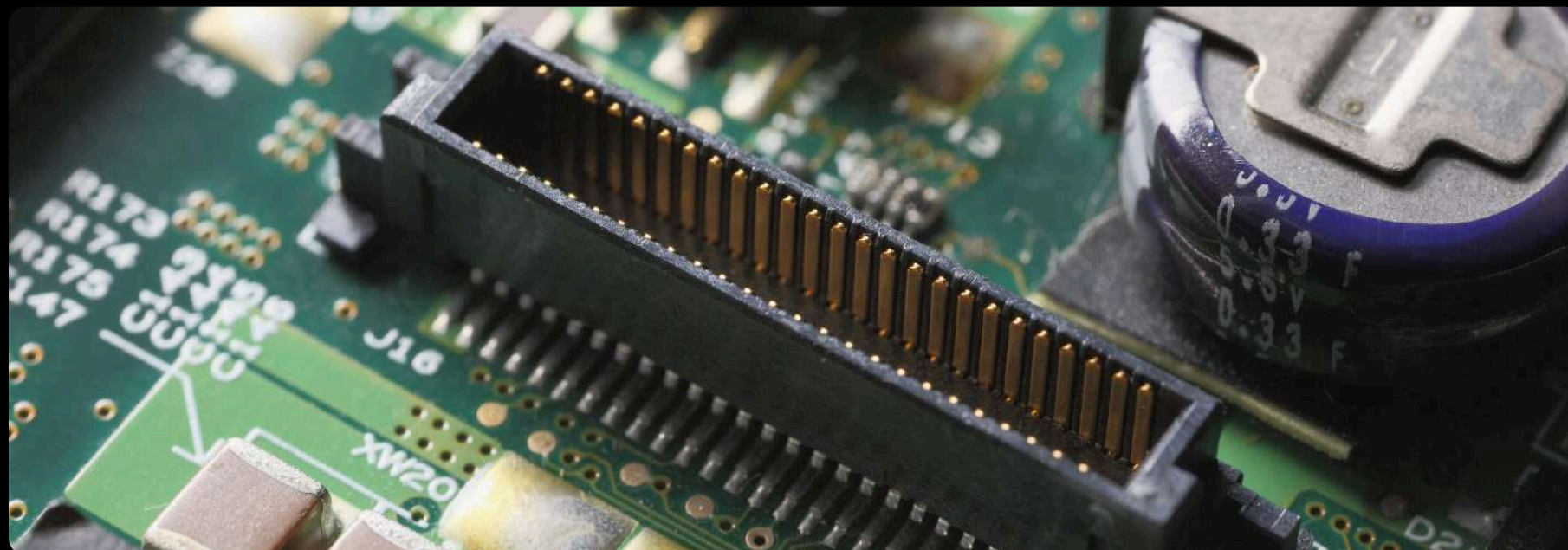
● SRIJA BOJJA

PREVENTION METHODS AND BEST PRACTICES

Preventing phishing attacks requires awareness, caution, and good cybersecurity habits. Users should always verify sender email addresses and avoid clicking unknown links or downloading suspicious attachments. Strong passwords and Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) provide additional security layers against unauthorized access. Installing antivirus software and keeping systems updated also help reduce cyber risks. Users should never share OTPs, passwords, or confidential information through calls, emails, or messages, even if the request appears genuine.

Safe internet usage is important for maintaining digital security and privacy. Users should access only trusted websites and avoid using public Wi-Fi networks for banking or sensitive activities. Password managers can help create and store strong passwords securely. Regularly monitoring account activity and changing passwords can help identify suspicious behavior early. It is also important to avoid clicking random advertisements, downloading files from untrusted sources, or sharing personal information unnecessarily online.





CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS QUIZ

Cybersecurity awareness quizzes help users understand phishing concepts more effectively. Questions may include identifying secure websites, recognizing suspicious emails, or understanding the importance of Two-Factor Authentication. Interactive learning methods improve engagement and help users remember cybersecurity best practices. Such quizzes also encourage users to think critically before responding to suspicious messages or entering personal information online.

Phishing is one of the most widespread and dangerous cyber threats in today's digital world. Attackers continuously develop new techniques to deceive users and steal sensitive information. However, awareness and safe online practices can significantly reduce the risk of becoming a victim. By carefully verifying emails, websites, and messages, using strong security measures, and staying informed about cyber threats, users can protect themselves and contribute to a safer digital environment.



THANK YOU SO MUCH

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